Tiffany Mao PRODUCT DESIGNER

tiffanymao.com · tiffanytfmao@berkeley.edu · linkedin.com/in/tiffanytfmao · Sunnyvale, CA

Product designer who ships her own front-end. I make consumer products that feel playful and alive (0→1 app flows, design systems, educational games, and physical interfaces), shaped by work across Astrocade, a seed-stage startup, Meta, and freelance clients.

EXPERIENCE

Designer / Astrocade — Oct 2026 – Present

- Designing the creator experience for an **AI game-creation platform with 10M monthly players**, where anyone can make and play games by describing them in plain language.
- Audited the creator experience end to end, tracing **7 core flows** across web, mobile, and backend code; the founders used the resulting roadmap to pick the team's next design project.
- Driving the redesign of how new creators get from an idea to their **first playable game**, backed by teardowns of 8 AI game makers, a prompt study (SQL + LLM classification), and four prototyped directions.

Freelance Product Designer — Aug 2024 – Aug 2025 · Remote

- Led **0→1 design for a pre-seed AI startup** as the only designer: brand, design system, and the entire MVP flow from blank page to shippable product.
- Redesigned the explore page for a **YC-backed no-code game-modding platform**, rebuilding discovery around how players and creators actually browse: SEO-informed IA plus community browsing patterns.
- Rebuilt a software studio's site with dark/light mode and redesigned its pricing page, turning a broken conversion flow into a working one.

Design Engineer / Cocoon — Apr 2023 – Jun 2024 · San Francisco

- Owned UX for pregnancy & disability leave across **3 core flows** (user interviews, legal alignment, and production React components), serving **50+ companies**.
- Built Cocoon's **first design system**: 20+ shared components adopted by 15 engineers, letting a 6-person team ship consistent UI without a designer in every loop.
- Led the company's first brand refresh, bringing visual consistency and ADA compliance to every user touchpoint.
- Drove alignment across design, engineering, legal, and ops through stakeholder interviews and design reviews, managing sign-off across 3 departments from kickoff to launch.

Software Engineer / Meta — Sep – Nov 2022 · Menlo Park

- Revamped Android UI components for Facebook's **video sharing** team, improving legibility and color accessibility across sizes at consumer scale.
- Designed and built React components for an internal pipeline tool, cutting user-error friction in a high-volume engineering workflow.

iOS Software Engineer Intern / Meta — Jun – Aug 2021 · Remote

- Shipped cross-posting components for **Facebook and Instagram Stories**, delivering a design-accurate eligibility page to millions of users.
- Audited Figma plugin graphics for color and text accessibility to meet WCAG compliance.

PLAY & PRODUCT

Graft! / cozy game about grafting plants — 3rd Place Judge's Award from IndieCade Game Jam · 2026

- Sole designer on a **6-person jam team**. Owned every user interaction and screen (menus, minigames, letters, and trait panels), set the hand-drawn visual direction, and built the UI prefabs in Unity for engineers to wire up.

The Wonder Workshop / cozy crafting game for kids — UC Berkeley × Common Sense Media · 2025

- Co-designed a crafting game for **ages 9–11** around a **zero-failure-state model**, so kids stay engaged through intrinsic motivation rather than punishment mechanics.
- Developed 3 critter companions, lesson structures, and core loops that teach color, texture, and form through play; designed scrapbook and order-book mechanics that build creative confidence without prescribing a right answer.

PalBits / customizable game controller — UC Berkeley · 2025

- Designed a modular handheld controller for **ages 8–12** where swappable physical parts evolve your in-game character; modeled the parts in Fusion 360.

SKILLS

Design	Product & interaction design, 0→1 product, visual design, design systems, game & play design, branding
Research	User interviews, usability testing, prototyping, analytics (SQL, Amplitude), accessibility (WCAG / ADA)
Build	HTML/CSS, JavaScript, React, p5.js · Figma, Framer, Adobe CC, Procreate, Claude Code

EDUCATION

University of California, Berkeley · Master of Design (MDes) — Expected Dec 2026

University of California, Berkeley · B.A. Computer Science — 2022